

cat magick:
summoning the
spirit of Bast
through sigil magick



by Anousen Leonte

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Introduction

This work is a small manual for evoking *Bast* through *sigil* magick. *Bast* or *Bastet* is an ancient Spirit known to the Egyptian people and which was symbolized with the body of a

woman and the head of a cat. As many are well aware, the Egyptians treated cats as sacred animals and mummified them in a manner quite similar to humans. *Bastet* was the Goddess of Cats or the "Cat Goddess", and was a very benevolent Goddess whose worshiped spanned over a thousand years in different forms. Other forms of her name were *Beset*, *Ubastis* and *Bubastis*, and the Greeks believed she was a form of *Isis*.

The name *Bast* or *Bastet* derives from the old Egyptian word *bas* which meant a vase or jar. In Egypt, these were often used to contain medicines and perfumes, so the dual notion of *healing* and *beautifying* are present in the idea of the goddess *Bastet*. In Egyptian esoterica—which was later appropriated by the Greeks in different forms—both *healing* and *beauty* have specifically feminine or goddess-oriented aspects to them. Some depictions of *Bastet* have the head of a lion which represents a purely Solar energy, whereas other times she has the head of a smaller, feral or domesticated cat which demonstrates a Lunar aspect to her also. As a lion she is a warrior goddess, conquering over evil, while as a cat she is more of a patron goddess, granting health, fertility and well-being. One of the few myths that has survived to the present day about *Bastet* is that she was the daughter of the Sun God *Ra*. *Ra* was in continual war with the evil serpent-God *Apep*, and every night they would fight. As *Ra* got older, however, his daughter *Bast* fought on his behalf, tracking down *Apep* one night and killing him for good. Another legend—recorded by the Greeks—records it that when *Typhon* (*Apep*, *Apophis*) made war against the Gods, *Apollo* (*Ra*) attacked him by transforming into a vulture, *Hermes* (*Thoth*, *Tahuti*) by transforming into an *Ibis*, and *Isis* (*Bastet*) by transforming into a cat—the trinity of which was enough to kill *Typhon* permanently. The Greeks also believed she corresponded perfectly to their own Goddess *Diana*, and claimed the Egyptians appealed to her for the safety and well being of pregnant women in particular. Her particular symbol was a *sistrum* which is a type of rattle:



Interestingly, in keeping with her connection with *Ra*, *Bast* or *Bastet* is primarily a Solar Goddess and was considered a form of the Sun. Esoterically, the Sun represents inward energy expanding outward, and is associated with the powers of creation, manifestation, projection, lucidity, presence, influence and stimulation, as well as the attributes of radiance, virility (or fertility), rulership, omnipresence and glamor. According to the Greek Hermetic mysteries, every Solar God or Goddess is simultaneously *all* the powers of the planets. This later was misconceived to be Monotheism when the Pharoah *Akhenaten* forbade the worship of any God or Goddess but *Aten*, the Sun. Later this was picked up by Moses who was trained by Egyptian priests who were still partisans of *Akhenaten*, and so developed the worship of *Adonai* (*Aten*) in the Abrahamic tradition. As the Sun is the center of the solar system, all the planets derive their energy from it. Deriving their energy from it, their power and influence, also, is derived. *Bastet*, being a solar Goddess, actually has powers over all the planets and may be accessed as such.

In this brief manual, I have given eight forms of *Bastet*; one primary form and then seven forms which correspond to each of the planets. I have also given two *sigils* each for the different forms. I recommend trying both and seeing which one works best for you, but there is no *meaning* to the *sigil* itself. Feel free to make your own *sigils* after trying these

out. Or not. Even though you will be successful using the methods I've given here, the real purpose of a book like this is to also inspire you to venture off into crafting your own rituals and systems as you become more accomplished and proficient at Spirit summoning—but, the bottom line is always *whatever works*.

Cats are, of course, a recurring theme in magickal lore. Of all animals, the three most common magickally oriented animals are the cat, the serpent and the toad. The cat is specifically a feminine energy, whereas the snake is masculine and the toad is hermaphroditic. For Egyptians, cats were almost purely benevolent and positive animals, and magickally they were associated with white magick. As cats were kept by people for companionship and to kill vermin, the cat represents magick in its positive sense of strengthening and giving peace to one's soul as well as protecting the magician from harm. It is associated with health, the home, fertility, the spirit and law. The serpent, in contrast, was not kept as a pet, and was revered as something with the power over life and death, as well as resurrection. It, therefore, is associated with conflict, foreign lands, asceticism, the body and lawlessness—at least in a negative sense. The toad, in contrast to both, is the middle, in that it is neither a beneficial or harmful animal to humans. It represents commerce or learning, the city, knowledge, the mind and communication.

This isn't quite as cut and dry as I've made it out to be, but this is the predominant trend in much of pre-Christian magickal interpretation. Later, all three were demonized.

How to Conduct a Simplified Ritual

Magick is not nearly as hard as it is often portrayed, and there are a great deal of misconceptions about magick. One of my first introductions to magickal evocation, for example, was the Goetic spirits of the Key of Solomon. Ritually, everything was very dramatic and difficult to do, involving special substances, Latin prayers, a triangle, banishings, licenses to depart, etc. It was only when I was introduced to the Olympicks that I saw that summoning could be comparatively easier from a material point of view—at least, if the Spirit in question was not exclusively evil. The Goetics are by far the most popular of Solomonic Spirits to evoke, but they are not the only Spirits. And experiments in Chaos Magick taught me also that one could summon Spirits from a variety of sources through *sigilizing* their names and constructing rituals around them. For more information on this, I have written another book entitled "*Evocation through Sigil Magick*" which goes into this in a little more detail.

To perform a simple summoning ritual for any spirit, I recommend having these items:

An altar

A painted, white or black picture frame to hold the *sigil*

Various white or black candle holders

Colored candles

Colored lamps (seven for each of the primary planets)

A rosary or set of beads

Incense

The Altar

An altar can be anything from a small table to your own construction. I recommend utilizing bricks, painted black. Lay a cloth over the bottom part, but allow a brick or two to actually hold the *sigil* frame in place.

The Sigil

A *sigil* is the seal or emblem of the Spirit. It is an abstract design which serves as a point of focus for the summoning, as well as a means of contacting the Spirit. I have given two *sigil* designs each for both the seven Planetary forms of *Bastet* and *Bastet* on her own. The first *sigil* design is based upon the Coptic Alphabet, and the second *sigil* is based on simple lines, circles, etc. These can be traced on paper, although I would recommend using calligraphy pens to do so.

In my other book, *Evocation Through Sigil Magick*, I give my rationale for utilizing modern made *sigils* for evoking ancient deities, as well as instructions on how to build them and evoke them properly. In addition to trying these *sigils*, feel free to create your own and note the different effects or strengths of the ritual.

The *sigil* itself should be placed in the center of the altar with a cloth over, keeping it hid. It will be unveiled during the ritual itself. While conducting the ritual you should look at the *sigil* and nothing else, until the presence of the Spirit manifests.

Colored Candles and Colored Lamps

These follow planetary correspondences and are designed to give the ritual a certain beneficial and magickally potent

ambience. Colored candles shouldn't be too difficult to figure out, but making lamps is a little harder. I recommend buying something which is clear glass that you can easily set a candle in, then painting it with heat resistant paint. You will likely need to a few coats, and a sponge brush works far better for coverage than a regular paint brush. I learned of this method recently and I find it helps put me in a magickal frame of mind quite quickly. I would recommend using both candles and colored lamps if possible.

The Beads

Chanting the name of the Spirit is a good means of also bringing it into manifestation. In my book *Evocation Through Sigil Magick* I recommend making an abstract mantra to recite in order to summon the Spirit, though one can also write a prayer in English or simply recite or sing the name of the Spirit in question.

Incense

This has much the same function as the candles and lamps, and one can consult an Astrological dictionary to see what best incenses to use for planetary correspondences. A good all-purpose one for *Bast* I have found is the scent of *Myrrh*.

The Ritual

After everything has been set up, the first step is to calm yourself for a few moments with your eyes closed. Ideally, the ritual should take place in the dark, with no light but the lamps/candles. At this time, take in the smell of the incense and the sense of anticipation filling the room.

Next, open your eyes and recite a prayer to the Spirit. Wait a moment in silence. Then, unveil the *sigil* and gaze upon it.

At this time you can recite the prayer again and wait, or recite the name of the Spirit with the beads, or use the abstract mantra. Do so until the Spirit comes.

Once the Spirit arrives, you can simply commune with her, ask her questions or make requests. When the time is right, bid the Spirit to depart.

Afterwards

Take a few moments to reflect on the ritual. Then, slowly and mindfully, place the *sigil* in its cloth, snuff out the incense, then the candles and then the lamps. Then put everything away. You can write about your feelings and experiences in your magickal journal for later reflection, also.

For each form of *Bastet* I have listed the name, the *sigil*, the planet, the use, the time, the candles/lamps, and the numbers.

The planetary or astrological correspondence of the particular manifestation of *Bast*. It is used to focus the ritual to a particular planetary energy. As *Bast* is a Solar Spirit primarily, it gives lights to all planets, so can manifest *through* them, also. This is similar to how a Mercurial Spirit may operate, although a Mercurial Spirit *couples* with another planet when it utilizes its force.

Then I list the use, or how the particular *sigil* and ritual may be used if one wants to cause direct effects to occur. It is, of course, not necessary to summon *Bast* with any use or gain in mind at all, but if you do these are some general, harmless ways of using the planets as manifestations of *Bast*.

The times, candle/lamp colors, and sacrifices are all culled from looking at their planetary correspondences. You can try the rituals at different times, but I would recommend trying

them on the timeframes given here to see for yourself if there is any difference in the manifestation.

If after many attempts, the spirit does not come, a degree of ascetic preparation may be in order. Magick can be easy to do if you put forth the effort to learn it, but this does not necessarily mean that your magick will be deep. American-style Capitalism likes to instill in everyone the idea of getting everything as quickly as possible without giving anything up for it, but this is simply not how human society's have lived except in Post-Industrial, Westernized and Corporate-controlled cultures. To sit in silence for an hour, to go through a day or two of fasting can be quite beneficial. When you deny yourself and give things up for the sake of an encounter with a spirit, it will not only put you in a very receptive state of mind, making the ritual *far* more effective than it otherwise would be, but it will also entice the spirit to show itself. All magickal systems throughout the world have utilized fasting, silence, mortification, etc. as means to prepare oneself for magickal practice, and flippancy or nonchalance have never been magick virtues—not only because it prepares you, but it is a fact that historically spirits have always been pleased with the sorcerer or magician giving up something to enter into the spirit's presence. Irregardless of where you look among the world's magick traditions, you will find this aspect. A simple version of it is to fast from all entertainments for two days, as well as all gossip, joking, laughter, and arguments, to sit in silence for an hour or two, or to fast from all foods or certain foods for a day or a set period of time.

And, finally, I give a series of numbers which represent this form of *Bast* in an abstract way. Can be used in place of the *sigil*, or in tandem with the *sigil* itself. These work as a more conceptual abstract design, rather than visual, and some

find them to be useful in addition to the *sigil* rather than utilizing the *sigil* alone.



Bast



Planet: None—here *Bast* is conceived as a totality, in her primary aspect

Uses: Communion with *Bast*, intuition, illumination and magickal power.

Time: Dawn or Twilight, after one day of not working (thus, if you're off on a Saturday, perform the ritual on a Sunday)

Candles: One black, one white.

Lamp: All seven colors.

Numbers: 298, 402, 67

Ra Bastet



Planet: The Sun

Uses: Contentedness, protection, health, majesty, the unveiling of secrets, rising in one's position, energy, lucidity and to be favored from above.

Time: Dawn

Candles: One gold or yellow candle and one deep red candle.

Lamp: Yellow.

Numbers: 379, 516, 86

Yah Bastet



Planet: The Moon

Uses: Serenity, mental strength, peaceful sleep, fearlessness, allaying depression, to become alluring, to slow the sense of time and to increase one's magickal ability.

Time: Midnight

Candles: One purple or violet candle and one white candle.

Lamp: White.

Numbers: 707, 606, 101

Tahut Bastet



Planet: Mercury

Uses: Foresight, persuasive communications, intellectual prowess, intellectual inspiration, patience, mental health, to silence gossipers, to find hidden knowledge and to increase magickal power.

Time: Afternoon

Candles: One orange candle and one green candle.

Lamp: Orange.

Numbers: 707, 822, 137

Neferu Bastet



Planet: Venus

Uses: Beauty, aesthetic appreciation, attracting a mate, aesthetic inspiration, serenity, health and general well being.

Time: Twilight, Night before Midnight

Candles: One pink candle, one white candle and one green candle.

Lamp: Green.

Numbers: 634, 816, 136

Heru Bastet



Planet: Mars

Uses: To rid oneself of an enemy, strength, energy, health, vitality and protection.

Time: Noon

Candles: Two red candles.

Lamp: Red.

Numbers: 591, 714, 119

Amun Bastet



Planet: Jupiter

Uses: Wealth, enthusiasm, protection, to attain friends, associates, and to increase one's standing.

Time: Daylight before Noon but after Dawn

Candles: Two blue candles and one white candle.

Lamp: Blue.

Numbers: 569, 696, 116

Chium Bastet



Planet: Saturn

Uses: Black magick, endurance and mystical inspiration.

Time: 2-4 A.M.

Candles: One black candle and one purple or violet candle.

Lamp: Purple.

Numbers: 548, 726, 121